Applying by the way of an online

Many companies require job applicants to use an online form, which can be tricky. Here are some tips that'll make it child's play for you.

Work out what's what

Take a close look at the form first to see exactly what you need to submit in what order and in what format.

Leave a message

If there's a box for leaving a personal message, use it. You can summarize the highlights from your CV that make you the perfect candidate in a brief profile two or three sentences long. Avoid tables, special characters, and spelling mistakes. Make sure you use as many key terms from the ad as possible without making your answers sound like they were written by a robot.

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form

TUM TIP

As well as the text boxes you need to fill in, use the upload function to submit a copy of your standard CV and, if relevant, a cover letter too.

Prepare your text

Write the bits of text that you'll need in Word first, check the spelling, then copy and paste them later into the form. The online application form might crash and won't pick up on any spelling errors. But this way your answers will be kept safe and sound and typo-free.

Add in your keywords

Many companies use computer software to scan documents submitted with a form in order to draw up a shortlist. Therefore, you should avoid tables, special characters, and spelling mistakes. Make sure you use as many key terms from the ad as possible without making your answers sound like they were written by a robot.

Take screenshots

Take screenshots or create PDFs to save copies of your documents so that you can still remember everything you've written later in a potential interview.

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